PUBLIC GOODS / WORKSHOP

Putting self-interest to work for the public good

An application of the Decentralized Curation framework

Decentralized Curation research by Ferit Tunçer.
Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden

Sponsored by Octant

Who decides?
Whose needs count?

ONE CURATOR

Can judge well.
May miss others' needs.

DEMOCRACY

Gives people a voice.
Votes alone do not ensure good judgment.

OPEN CURATION

Anyone can take part.
Reward honesty, care and competence.

Personal rewards for honest, competent and careful judgment can also create public benefit.

Curate what matters.
Distribute when ready.

Define the goal and criteria Organizing group

Nominate
Claims + evidence + deposit

→

Judge relevance
Drawn jury

→

Relative weights
Funding is one possible use

Challenge claims Appeal a disputed score Reassess periodically

Assessment costs need funding; a beneficiary budget can arrive later

Define the goal.
Publish the criteria.

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

0.00	0.25	0.50	0.75	1.00
not infrastructure	matters to one field	relied on in several fields	widely relied on	critical across research

Evidence + Criteria + Reward rules

One example: research infrastructure

A claim you can check.

> NUMPY 2.0.0
>
> “Released on 16 June 2024.”

Claim → Evidence → Deposit

The deposit rewards anyone who successfully challenges a false claim

05 / RELEVANCE JURY

One jury.
Different judgments.

6 seats · 3 jurors

Juror A Seats: 3 — 0.700



Juror B Seats: 2 — 0.400



Juror C Seats: 1 — 0.700



MEAN WEIGHTED BY SEATS

0.600

(3 × 0.70 + 2 × 0.40 + 1 × 0.70) ÷ 6 = 0.600

Seal privately → reveal

Deposits enter a draw for paid jury work; one juror may hold several seats

Dispute a score?
Fund an appeal.

INITIAL JURY

6

seats · score **0.600**

→

CONTESTED APPEAL

12

seats · score **0.700**

8 at 0.800; 4 at 0.500

Competing fully funded scores go to a larger jury.

An appeal challenges an existing score; a later reassessment asks what matters now

07 / FUNDING FOLLOWS THE SCORE

Curated shares.
Ready for any budget.

WEIGHTS → NORMALIZED SHARES

Contribution	Weight	Share	Units/day
NumPy	0.600	40.0%	0.00
Archive	0.300	20.0%	0.00
Registry	0.600	40.0%	0.00



NUMPY'S SHARE

40.0%

Illustrative distribution: **0** units/day

0 × 40.0% = 0.00 units/day

INITIAL ASSESSMENT; ELIGIBLE FOR FUNDING

Weights express relative priority, not measured public benefit. Set the budget to zero: the weights and shares remain.

Challenge claims. Reward fact-checking.

SUPPOSE A NOMINATION FALSELY CLAIMS

> “NumPy 2.0 was released in 2020.”
>
> The release record says 16 June 2024.

Challenge → External arbitrator →

Challenge succeeds?

Deposit to fact-checker; nomination ends

Successful fact-checker gets the deposit. Future funding stops; past earnings remain earned.

Reassess periodically.
Update the weights.

INITIAL SCORE

0.600

→

LATER SCORE

0.300

NUMPY / DAY

25.00

Lower weight takes effect immediately. Earlier accrual stays earned; only future accrual uses the new shares.

A fresh assessment updates current relevance; an appeal contests an existing score

Honesty, care and competence.

HONESTY

Report sincerely.

CARE

Assess evidence rigorously.

COMPETENCE

Know how to judge it.

Score independently. Coherence is rewarded.

Fees support careful work. The game aims to make honesty the shared focal point: a Schelling point. Repeated losses reduce future influence.

Now you are the jury.



https://decentralized-curation.0xferit.workers.dev/r/leiden

Name → seat → score

No wallet. Workshop points only.

Judge the work.
Use the same question.

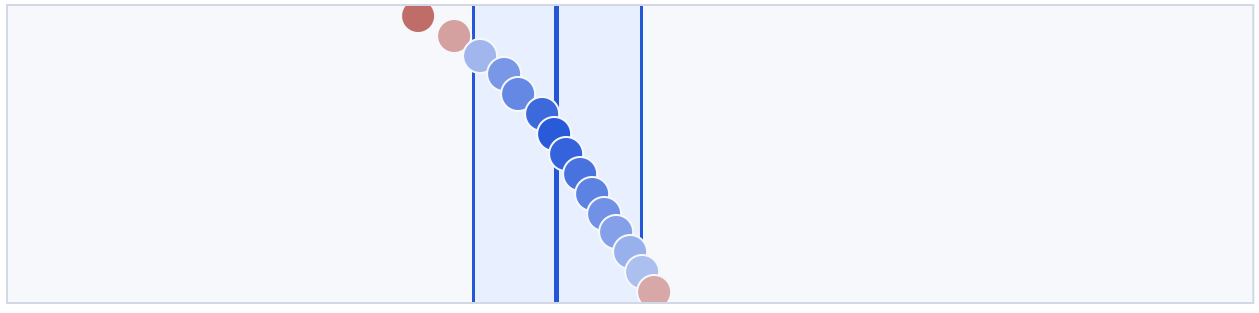
How much does this nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

0.00	0.25	0.50	0.75	1.00
not infrastructure	matters to one field	relied on in several fields	widely relied on	critical across research

how many rely · role in research · other options

Brief descriptions and prior knowledge; use the shared criteria and explain your evidence.

How your scores earn points.



0.00 Drag a juror; arrow keys also work 1.00

result	spread	zone	inside	losing points
0.44	0.055	±0.068	12	3

Blue: inside. Red: outside.

GROUP RESULT

Average of the scores

REWARD ZONE

Set by the spread of scores

POINTS

Closer to the result earns more

A contribution’s score sets its relevance. Your reward depends on how you judge it.

6 nominees.
Your judgment.

01
Inkscape

02
Linux

03
PDF

04
LaTeX

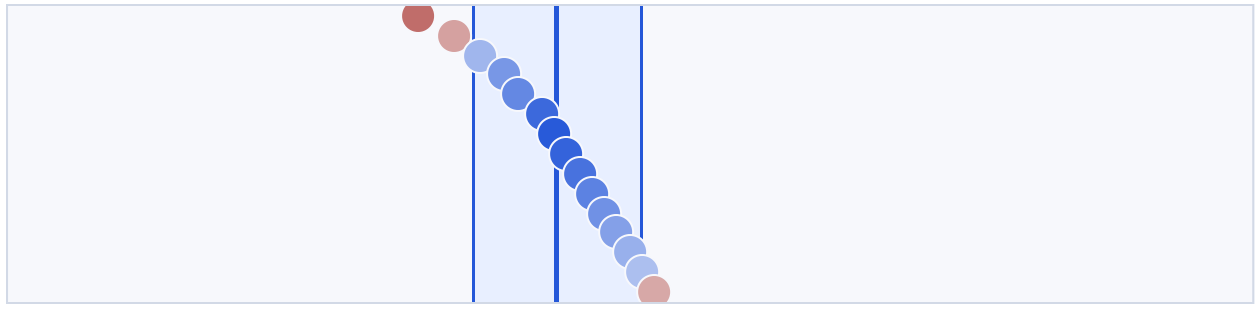
05
arXiv

06
NumPy

Read → Score alone → Seal → Open together

Keep the secret words used to seal your score private. Explain your evidence after revelation.

Did our scores follow the evidence?



result	spread	zone	inside	losing points
0.44	0.055	±0.068	12	3

Blue: inside. Red: outside. Outline: assigned bloc at 0.90; lowest starting scores join first.

Bloc share of stake 0%

What did we reward?

What shaped the group result?

What would change your mind?

Similar scores can come from a shared mistake. This exercise does not establish resistance to collusion.

Every defense has a boundary.

Attack	Response	Still exposed
Shift the criteria	Published goal and criteria	Bad policy; shared bias
Copy a score	Seal → reveal	Early reveals; coordination
Capture the jury	Deposit-based draw	Concentrated stake
Keep a bad ruling	Publicly funded appeal	Cost; shared bias
Prove a sealed score to a buyer	Workshop only: penalty + bounty	Other verification routes remain

Discuss which defenses help, and where each could fail.

Make scrutiny worthwhile.

Reward honest, competent and careful judgment.
Make personal benefit serve the public good.

Sponsored by Octant